Electric Vehicle Adoption in Rental Fleets

Academic strategy project • edited public portfolio version

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Project context

An academic strategy project exploring barriers to battery-electric vehicle (BEV) adoption in rental fleets and possible responses from rental operators. This public version is not an official Volkswagen Financial Services document and does not disclose interviewee identity, personal contact details or private third-party comments.

Problem framing

Potential barriers include upfront vehicle cost, charging access, uncertainty about residual values, range concerns, operational downtime and differences between individual and fleet customer needs. These barriers vary by location, vehicle type, usage profile and policy environment.

Audience segmentation

Individual renters may value simple charging instructions, transparent pricing and confidence about journey range. Fleet customers may prioritise total cost of ownership, charging availability at depots, vehicle utilisation and predictable maintenance.

Strategic options

1. Education: provide clear, practical EV handover guidance and route/charging information.
2. Charging partnerships: collaborate with charging networks, energy suppliers and destination operators.
3. Fleet pilots: test EVs on routes and duty cycles suited to their range and charging profile.
4. Commercial packages: explain charging, maintenance and cost assumptions transparently.
5. Used-EV confidence: offer evidence-based battery, warranty and condition information where available.

Evaluation approach

Assess each option against customer value, implementation cost, operational feasibility, emissions impact, data quality and measurable adoption outcomes. A pilot should establish a baseline and define success measures before launch.

Suggested measures

EV share of bookings; conversion rate after EV information is shown; charging-related support contacts; vehicle utilisation; customer satisfaction; charging cost per rental; operational downtime; and lifecycle emissions where reliable data are available.

Limitations

Any market statistics, policy details and cost comparisons used in a live version should be dated and cited to reliable sources. This edited portfolio version intentionally omits unverified historical figures, third-party quotations and private contact details.